

1 MILLION SPERM WHALES WERE KILLED BEFORE HUNTING THEM WAS BANNED IN 1981

Migration

Whales travel to cold waters near the poles to feed, then move to warmer waters closer to the equator to breed. Few species migrate across the equator, so there can be separate populations in the northern and southern hemispheres.



KEY

- **Breeding areas** Warmer waters for giving birth
- **Feeding areas** Cooler waters that are rich in food
- ↔ **Migration routes** Breeding-to-feeding areas and back
- **Site of spectacular whale behavior**

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8. Sri Lanka

Between December and April, Dondra Point, on Sri Lanka's southern tip, is the best place to see blue whales. Unlike most populations of blue whales, this one does not migrate to polar waters to feed. These northern Indian Ocean blue whales both breed and feed year round in tropical waters.

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9. Antarctica

Antarctic orcas often hunt in teams, herding their prey together before attacking from different angles. They will also tip over ice floes to knock penguins and seals into the water.

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10. Northwest Pacific

In winter, the humpbacks of the western Pacific mate and calve in warm, subtropical waters from the Philippines to Japan. Summer sees them traveling to feed in the extreme north of the Pacific, around the Aleutian Islands.

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11. Kaikoura, New Zealand

This one of few places in the world where sperm whales can be seen year round. They are attracted by an underwater canyon close to the shore that has abundant marine life, including the giant squid that the whales hunt.